

Newsletter



Rossholme was set up by Joyce Aruga in the Kiambiu Slum in Nairobi with just 10 pupils in September 2016.

Thanks to Joyce's determination, hard work and resilience, and with the support of Judy Webb in Somerset, Rossholme has gone from strength to strength and now provides sound education and pastoral care to 96 pupils within its corrugated iron shack with just six rooms, two flat-bed toilets and an external water tap. We don't ask questions about its limited electricity supply!

Wearing uniform to school in Kenya is really important and the navy and bright yellow Rossholme uniforms are very popular – and noticeable. They also provide a significant link

between Rossholme old and new!

Rossholme is really thriving and so much has happened in the past year, not the least of which was Joyce's wedding to Jacob de Kiage in December. Jacob teaches Maths in a High School within another slum area and he is wonderfully supportive of Joyce and Rossholme.

Now we are now established as a UK based charity, Registered Charity Number 1178553, and we felt it was time to initiate a regular newsletter to let our supporters and others know what was happening. This is therefore our FIRST NEWSLETTER and we will always appreciate input from visitors and others who are keen to support us.

Establishment as a charity means that we can claim Gift Aid on all donations made by UK taxpayers and also enabled us to set up a MyDonate account to which donations may be made safely and securely without charge. Links to these and Amazon Smile can be found easily on our website Charity page.

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We have been sending money regularly to Joyce to enable her to pay her rent and staff salaries and we are very grateful to those supporters who have been making regular contributions to our account. There are no administrative charges so every penny goes straight out to support the school. No matter how small, every donation really does make a difference and the fact that we can now claim the Gift Aid element of 25% from UK tax payers helps enormously.

You can also read about the contribution of 0.5% made on every Amazon purchase on our website Charity Page.

Two girls from Somerset, Tessa Gaukroger and Susie Pincock, visited Rossholme in Kenya in May and put together a blog and vlog featuring Joyce and the school, for BBC Radio Somerset which was transmitted on their Breakfast programme on 5th June. It was also picked up by BBC Points West TV which featured a 7 minute slot on their evening programme the same day.

Ruth Campbell, an Army friend of Judy's, owns and runs Pine Rivers Yoga in Brisbane, Australia and they have been incredibly supportive in raising money for Rossholme. Her daughter, Eve Massingham works as an International Lawyer with the ICRC in Nairobi and she and her husband Sean have been instrumental in setting up a lunch programme which they fund. David Grace, based in Switzerland, and his wife Lucy, herself Kenyan from Nairobi, have been providing the funds and equipment for breakfasts.

The school has just broken up for the summer and will be back for the Autumn Term at the end of August. Last Autumn, we launched a special fundraising effort for the children to go on a visit to Wilson Airport and the Animal Orphanage in Nairobi where these children could see some of their wonderful wild animals for the first time. It was hugely successful with them all travelling in a luxury coach which made quite an impression within the slum area. There was sufficient money left over from the fund raising to pay for a 'Graduation Ceremony' for the older children. We'd like to do the same again this year and Joyce is planning a visit to the David Sheldrick Trust Elephant Orphan Centre. Any contributions will be gratefully received on the MyDonate website.

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